



Consulting Website Migration Brief

Everything a new Claude Code session needs to move this site
off Manus without taking it offline.

SITE	The consulting website
LIVES ON	Manus (to be replaced)
CODE	Already on GitHub
DOMAIN	Registered at Hostinger
STATUS	LIVE — must stay up throughout
TARGET	GitHub Pages, auto-deploy on push

Companion document to the 7Band Website Operations & Recovery Manual.

SECTION 1

Start Here

This site is the second migration off Manus. The first one — 7Band Financial Agency — is already done and running on this exact setup, so the pattern is proven.

THE ONE DIFFERENCE THAT CHANGES EVERYTHING

The first site was already down when it was migrated. There was nothing to protect, so DNS was repointed immediately.

This site is live and serving customers. That reverses the order of operations: the new hosting must be built and fully verified **before** a single DNS record is touched. Done in that order, visitors never see an outage.

Why the site is being moved

Manus hosted the first 7Band site. When that account was deleted, the hosting and every image hosted there vanished at the same moment and the business site was down for days. The code was safely on GitHub, which turned out not to be enough — code backup is not site backup. This migration removes the same single point of failure from the consulting site before it can fail.

What the target setup looks like

Piece	Provider	Job
Domain	Hostinger	Registration only.
DNS	Hostinger	Points the name at GitHub.
Files	GitHub repo	The site's source, version-controlled.
Hosting	GitHub Pages	Serves the site. Free.
Deployment	GitHub Actions	Rebuilds and republishes on every push to main.

SECTION 2

Rules Learned the Hard Way

Each of these cost real time on the first migration. Read them before touching anything.

DO NOT ADD GITHUB'S IP ADDRESSES AT HOSTINGER

Standard GitHub Pages instructions say to create four **A records** pointing at 185.199.108.153 and friends. **Hostinger does not need them.** Hostinger offers an **ALIAS** record, which does the same job and follows GitHub automatically if their addresses ever change. Adding A records alongside an ALIAS record creates a conflict.

Correct records on the first site — use the same shape here:

```
CNAME www -> <github-username>.github.io
```

```
ALIAS @ -> <github-username>.github.io
```

DO NOT TOUCH THE EMAIL DNS RECORDS

Every MX record, and every entry mentioning hostingermail, mailgun, leadconnectorhq, DKIM, SPF or DMARC, exists to keep business email working. They have nothing to do with the website. Changing or deleting one breaks email delivery, and that failure is silent until someone notices mail is missing.

The rest of the list

- **Pull every image off Manus into the repository first.** This is what caused the worst damage last time — the logo, a portrait and two backgrounds were stored on Manus cloud rather than in the project, and two were never recovered. Before anything else, inventory every image the site loads and commit the files into the repo.
- **GitHub Pages must be switched on by hand the first time.** A workflow cannot create a Pages site from nothing. In the repo: **Settings** → **Pages** → **Source: GitHub Actions**. The first automated deploy fails until this is done.
- **Free GitHub Pages requires a public repository.** A private repo needs GitHub Pro (about \$4/month). Making a repo private on a free plan takes the site offline instantly.
- **A CNAME file goes in the published folder** containing the domain, so Pages knows which custom domain to answer for.
- **Strip the platform's own code.** The first site carried Manus build plugins, a debug collector, a storage proxy and an analytics tag that could never work again. Search the project for the platform's name and remove what it finds.
- **Add an SPA fallback** if the site is a single-page app, or direct links to interior pages will 404.

SECTION 3

Order of Operations

Follow this sequence and the site never goes down. The DNS change is last, and only after the new hosting is confirmed working.

Phase 1 — Prepare, with nothing switched over

- 1 Clone the repo and get the site building locally. Confirm it builds clean before changing anything.
- 2 Inventory every image and asset the live site loads. Anything served from a Manus address must be downloaded and committed into the repository.
- 3 Remove the platform's build plugins, analytics and runtime code.
- 4 Add the GitHub Actions deploy workflow and the CNAME file.

Phase 2 — Stand up the new hosting alongside the old

- 1 In the repo, set **Settings** → **Pages** → **Source: GitHub Actions**. Leave the custom domain field empty for now — filling it in early can disturb the live site.
- 2 Push to main and let the deploy run.
- 3 Open the temporary address — `<username>.github.io/<repo>` — and check the site thoroughly. Expect styling to look wrong at this address if the site is built for a domain root; judge content and structure, not layout.
- 4 Fix anything broken and redeploy until it is right. The live site is untouched throughout this phase.

Phase 3 — The switch

- 1 Enter the custom domain in **Settings** → **Pages** and save.
- 2 At Hostinger, change the **www** CNAME and the **@ ALIAS** from the Manus target to `<username>.github.io`. Change nothing else.
- 3 Wait for GitHub's DNS check to pass, then for the HTTPS certificate to be issued. Minutes to a couple of hours; a browser security warning in the meantime is normal and clears itself.
- 4 Tick **Enforce HTTPS** once it becomes available.
- 5 Test the live domain in a private window and on a phone using mobile data.

ROLLBACK

If anything goes wrong after the DNS change, the old Manus target can be put back in those two records and the site returns to its previous host. **Record the exact original values before changing them** — that is the entire rollback plan, and it takes ten seconds to save.

SECTION 4

Verify Before Declaring Done

The first migration shipped several bugs that a proper check would have caught. Run all of these.

Check	What good looks like
Every page loads	In both the live domain and a private window. No 404s.
No broken images	No broken-image icons. Check every page, not just the homepage.
Every link works	Especially menu links. One dead nav link sat live for weeks on the first site.
Booking / contact links	Open them and confirm the destination actually loads.
Contact details	One consistent email address across the whole site. The first site had two, one of them a domain that was not owned.
Mobile	No sideways scrolling; tap targets big enough; text readable.
Browser console	No JavaScript errors on any page.
HTTPS	Padlock present, Enforce HTTPS ticked.
Email still working	Send a test message to and from the business address after the DNS change.

Once it is live

- Turn on auto-renew for the domain. An expired domain takes down the site and the email together.
- Keep two-factor authentication on GitHub, Hostinger and email. Those three accounts are the whole business now.
- Do not delete the Manus account until the new site has run clean for at least a week.
- Every image the site uses belongs in the repository. No exceptions. That single rule would have prevented most of what was lost the first time.

How to use this brief

Hand this document to the new Claude Code session at the start, along with the 7Band Website Operations & Recovery Manual. Between them they carry the full setup, the conventions, and the mistakes already paid for — so the second migration starts where the first one finished.